

The 1995 Dayton Peace Accord provided only a brief respite from troubles in the area.

AFTERMATH

The Dayton Peace Accord ruled that Bosnia would be **split** into the **Bosnian Serb Republic** and the **Muslim–Croat Federation**. Radovan Karadzic and Ratko Mladic were both indicted for **war crimes**. Karadzic was captured in 2008 to face trial at the Hague, but Mladic remains at large.

KOSOVO

Hundreds of people were injured in ethnic violence in Kosovo following the **Kosovo War** (1996–99). A nervous peace now exists in the region.

WAR CRIMES

Slobodan Milosevic lost the Serbian presidential election in 2000. He refused to accept the result, but was **forced out of office** by strikes and massive protests. He was handed over to a **UN war crimes tribunal** in the Hague, in the Netherlands, and put on trial for **crimes against humanity and genocide**. He spent five years in prison and died of a heart attack shortly before the trial was concluded.

SERBIA-MONTENEGRO

In February 2003, what remained of Yugoslavia was replaced with a loose federation called **Serbia and Montenegro**. On June 3, 2006 Montenegro formally declared its independence.

IDEAS

UNITED NATIONS

The name “United Nations” was first used in World War II when 26 nations pledged to continue fighting against the Axis Powers: Germany, Italy, and latterly Japan. Based in New York, the United Nations officially came into existence on October 24, 1945, when its charter was ratified by China, France, the Soviet Union, the UK, and the US. The charter gives the UN Security Council the power to take collective action in maintaining international peace and security. Although soldiers deployed by the UN share a uniform, they remain members of their respective armed forces. In July 1998 in Rome, the 120 Member States of the UN adopted a treaty to establish a permanent international criminal court.



Although the international community imposed economic sanctions on Serbia, UN troops in Bosnia were prohibited from using military force. Throughout 1993, confident that the UN would not take military action, Serbs continued to commit atrocities. Over a million people were driven from their homes by Serb forces under Radovan Karadzic, president of the Bosnian Serb Republic.

UN intervention

In 1994, a marketplace in Sarajevo was struck by a Serb mortar shell, killing 68 people. Scenes of the carnage were relayed around the globe, intensifying calls for intervention. The US issued an ultimatum through the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) demanding that the Serbs withdraw their arms from Sarajevo. The Serbs complied and a NATO-imposed ceasefire was declared.

Diplomatic efforts, however, did not stop Serbs from attacking Muslim towns in Bosnia, many of which had been declared “Safe Havens” by the UN. In



Kosovo

NATO peacekeeping troops clamber through an abandoned house in Kosovo. Forces were sent in following the 1999 war between the Serbian government and Kosovan Albanians fighting for independence from Serbia.

one “Safe Haven” at Srebrenica, UN peacekeeping forces watched helplessly as Serbs under General Ratko Mladic slaughtered an estimated 8,000 men and boys—the worst mass murder in Europe since the end of World War II. Serb forces also took hundreds of UN troops hostage and used them as human shields, chained to military targets.

In August 1995, NATO war planes began a fierce air campaign against Serb troops throughout Bosnia, and the Serb

leader Slobodan Milosevic finally agreed to peace talks. Three weeks later the Dayton Peace Accord was declared.

This was not the end of the wars in Yugoslavia, however. Fighting between ethnic Albanian minorities and the Macedonian and Serbian governments continued. In Kosovo, this led to a new NATO bombing campaign in 1999. Eventually, Serb forces withdrew from Kosovo and in 2006 the province formally declared its independence.

